

The 6:15

SATURDAY · SEPTEMBER 5, 2026

NO. 11

THE BOARD

CALENDAR (NEXT 10 DAYS) · WEEKEND EDITION

Sun 9/6	OPEC+ core-7 reviews quotas, expected held steady
Mon 9/7	Labor Day — markets closed
Tue 9/8	Canada's ~\$27.6B retaliatory tariffs take effect
Thu 9/10	Aug. PPI + claims, 8:30a; Adobe & Oracle report after close
Fri 9/11	Aug. CPI, 8:30a — Waller's decisive input (falls Fri, not Thu)
Tue-Wed 9/15-16	FOMC decision/SEP; DE primary; Starship Fl. 14 (NET, soft)

Correction: Oracle's Q1 FY27 date is Wed 9/10 after close, not Mon 9/14 as carried previously — now same day as Adobe. No verified rocket launch, AI release, or VC round fell in a confirmed 24-48h window beyond continuity items below.

METRICS · FRI 9/4 CLOSES UNLESS NOTED

Equities/vol	S&P 7,718.60 (-0.38%), Dow 53,414.25 (-0.51%), Nasdaq 26,506.99 (-0.29%); VIX 14.32 (single-sourced)
Rates/FX	10Y ~4.79% (+3-5bp); 2Y/30Y not verified ; DXY 99.17 (+0.21%)
Oil/Gold	Brent disputed (\$94.71/\$95.23/\$97.36) ; WTI \$91.48 (single-sourced); gold spot ~\$4,392 vs. futures ~\$4,522 unreconciled
Gas	\$4.15/gal natl. avg (AAA via aggregator, 9/4) secondary source

No Asia/Europe closes to report (weekend). All gave back Thursday's Waller-driven rally after the jobs beat repriced Fed-hike odds higher — see Lead.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Closure	Day 188 (straits.live, as of 9/5 10:13 UTC)
Transits	straits.live stale to 8/30 (6 vessels, 7% of baseline); Kpler's 4-vessel 9/4 figure via secondary aggregator

only **unconfirmed**; Lloyd's List ~14/day (Aug 17-23, cargo >10k dwt only, not comparable); PortWatch's freshest cite a "since-March" ~7/day average **stale**

Official vs. tracker	Bessent claims 10-17M bbl/day; Trump claims 30-40 ships/day — no tracker corroborates either unverified claims
Strikes (24h)	CENTCOM continued strikes on Iranian targets 9/4 (incl. 2 unidentified ships); no 3rd night of Iranian launches after 9/2-9/3 — tentative pause, not a declared stand-down
War-risk	40x pre-crisis multiplier, unchanged (straits.live); Crisis Pressure Index 91 "extreme"; JMIC rates risk "severe"

Methodology note, unchanged: Kpler's near-real-time AIS counts, Lloyd's List's slower cargo-only weekly aggregation, PortWatch's baseline snapshots, and official government claims measure different things over different windows, several unverified — never netted or averaged against each other.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Lost Padres 4-1 Fri 9/4. 80-61, 2nd AL East, 4.0 GB Tampa Bay (84-57)
Knicks	Hart extension unsigned; 3-yr/~\$60-62M still the reported favorite (4-yr/\$81M figure was recycled 2023 reporting)
Northwestern	Opens tonight vs. South Dakota State, 8p ET — after this press time

LEAD

JOBS BEAT, MARKETS FLINCH

August payrolls blow past consensus; markets read the beat as bad news for the Fed's dovish wing just as Waller's own decisive data point comes into view

Friday's August jobs report landed far above expectations: nonfarm payrolls rose 162,000 against a Dow Jones consensus of roughly 53,000-55,000, the strongest monthly gain since March, while the unemployment rate held at 4.1% and average hourly earnings rose

\$0.10 (0.3%) to \$37.75. One wire account put July's payroll figure — originally reported as a 23,000 decline — revised up to a 21,000 gain, though that specific revision number could not be independently corroborated this run and should be treated as provisional.

The market's reaction was the more consequential fact. Stocks fell across the board Friday: the S&P 500 dropped 0.38% to 7,718.60, the Dow lost 271.86 points (0.51%) to 53,414.25, and the Nasdaq Composite eased 0.29% to 26,506.99 — each index giving back all or most of Thursday's Waller-driven rally in a single session. Treasury yields and the dollar moved the opposite way: the 10-year rose to roughly 4.79% from Thursday's 4.74-4.75% close, and the DXY firmed 0.21% to 99.17, extending off Thursday's low rather than continuing its Waller-triggered slide. Gold fell, though quote services disagree sharply on the size of the move — spot near \$4,392/oz against December futures near \$4,522, a roughly \$130 gap this run could not reconcile. Fed-funds futures did the real repricing: odds of a hike at the Sept. 15-16 FOMC meeting rose from Thursday's near-coin-flip level to a majority favoring a hike, with individual readings this run ranging from roughly 58% to 63% depending on the source and moment sampled.

The mechanism is the same Fed split that led Thursday's issue, now running into its own logic. Governor Waller's case for holding rates in September rested on two legs: a labor market that had already shown one outright monthly decline (July's since-revised -23,000 shock) and a disinflation trend he wanted two more weeks of data to confirm before deciding. He was explicit that the Sept. 11 CPI print, not Friday's payrolls, would be his decisive input. Friday's number doesn't touch the CPI leg of that argument directly, but it knocks out

the labor-market leg that made a "cooling economy, no urgency to hike" narrative easy to sell — a 162,000 print with earnings still rising 0.3% month-over-month is not the picture Waller was implicitly leaning on when he invoked Lennon on Thursday. Markets, in other words, aren't pricing a policy mistake or a recession scare; they're pricing a stronger hand for Chair Warsh's hawkish framing heading into the meeting that matters. The VIX actually fell to 14.32 on the session (**single-sourced**), consistent with a repricing read rather than a growth scare.

That leaves the Sept. 10 PPI-and-claims cluster and, especially, the Sept. 11 CPI print as the two remaining inputs before the Sept. 15-16 decision — and CPI now carries more weight than it did Thursday, precisely because the jobs report took away the argument that a soft labor market alone justifies a hold. A hot core CPI print a week from Friday would leave Waller with neither leg of his Thursday case standing; a soft one would still leave him needing to explain away Friday's beat to the rest of the committee. Either way, the coin flip Thursday's Waller remarks created didn't survive the weekend intact.

BUSINESS

Lululemon fell 17-18% Friday after Thursday's after-close Q2 report: revenue declined 4% y/y to \$2.4B, worse than the company's own guided 2-3% decline, with comparable sales down 9% driven largely by China Mainland weakness that one outlet tied to a "viral drum controversy"; Q3 EPS guidance implies roughly a 60% y/y decline. Snowflake continued reacting to its Sept. 2-3 print: adjusted EPS of \$0.62 beat the \$0.45 consensus, on revenue of \$1.55B, roughly 4.9% above estimates. NHTSA opened an investigation into the roughly 1,000 steering-wheel-less Cybercabs Tesla began

commercially deploying in Austin on Sept. 3, probing whether the vehicles meet federal motor-vehicle safety standards under Tesla's own self-certification — a structure echoing the multi-year Zoox probe; shares slid on the news. No new development surfaced this run on Amazon's FTC antitrust response or the Nvidia-Hugging Face deal.

GEOPOLITICS

A Russian jet-powered attack drone struck the headquarters of Ukraine's security service (SBU) in central Kyiv, across from St. Sophia's Cathedral, late Thursday into Friday, injuring nine people (two seriously) per a rough consensus of CNN, Kyiv Independent and ABC News reporting after initial counts ranged 7-12. President Zelensky said the strike targeted the office of acting SBU chief Oleksandr Poklad specifically — Poklad was unhurt — and ordered a "symmetrical" response; the jet-powered-drone tactic extends the shift away from slower nightly waves flagged in the prior issue. Ukraine separately struck two Russian oil refineries more than 800km from the border, reportedly halting operations at both, per a cluster of wire reports not yet tied to one named outlet (**single-cluster sourced**). One Ukrainian outlet reported Zelensky proposed an "air ceasefire" to U.S. envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner, after which Russia's defense ministry announced fresh strikes (**single-sourced, unconfirmed**). Xi's Sept. 24 Washington summit remains on the calendar — Beijing has not formally confirmed the visit — with trade, Taiwan, AI and Iran-war fallout reportedly on the agenda; CNBC characterized expectations as management rather than resolution.

IRAN & HORMUZ

See The Board for the full Hormuz-counters breakdown. Beyond the transit and strike data logged there, Vice President Vance's Sept. 3 remark is more precisely quoted, per CNN, Washington Times and Time transcripts, as Iran's "grip on the Strait of Hormuz is effectively gone" — not, as an earlier issue paraphrased it, that "the exchange"

itself is "effectively over." He also called the six-week exchange "not a war" and set no timeline for resolution; no follow-up statement surfaced Sept. 4-5. Iran's president said Sept. 1 he remained open to reverting to the June ceasefire framework if the U.S. reciprocated, but that predates this window, and Vance's Sept. 3 remarks — no active talks reported — cut against any near-term movement on it.

SPORTS

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Continuity. Dropped as unchanged since 9/4: House Speaker Johnson's canceled floor votes; Trump's midterm-impeachment remark (still single-sourced); the Markey and CO-8 primaries; Amazon's FTC antitrust response; the Nvidia-Hugging Face deal; GPT-6 Astra's pending wider rollout; Anthropic's post-Labor Day IPO-prospectus timeline (a Sept. 3 report added a reported \$15B pre-IPO credit facility led by Morgan Stanley, still unconfirmed by the company itself). For next issue: Sunday's OPEC+ quota decision; the corrected Sept. 10 Adobe/Oracle earnings pileup alongside PPI and claims; the Sept. 11 CPI print, now carrying more weight after Friday's jobs beat weakened the labor-market leg of Waller's case for holding; whether Iran's pause in retaliation holds or the SBU-strike tempo in Ukraine escalates further; Saturday night's Yankees-Padres finale and Northwestern's opener, both past this press time; Kpler's primary-source transit count once its site is reachable again.

Unverified figures are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.